

AI Adoption Rubric

Goal: To help everyone understand and navigate AI adoption expectations, so we can continue to excel in our roles.

Note: Is anything in this doc confusing, missing, or in any way not as helpful as it should be? Please send an email to Syed with details. Thanks!
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Introduction

This rubric defines how we expect every team member at Awesome Motive to adopt AI tools in their work. AI is not a novelty or a shortcut. It's a core competency that will determine our ability to move faster, serve customers better, and outpace competitors.

Why This Matters

The companies that win in the next decade will be those that integrate AI into every function, not as a replacement for human judgment, but as an amplifier of it. We've already seen AI transform several areas of our operations. Now we need to raise the bar across every team and role.

This rubric exists to make expectations clear, provide a path for growth, and ensure we're all moving in the same direction.

The Four Levels

Unacceptable — You are not meeting the minimum expectations for AI adoption in your role. If you're here, your immediate priority is moving to Capable.

Capable — You are using AI tools in your day-to-day work. You understand what AI can do in a basic sense, you verify outputs before using them, and you're saving some time on routine tasks but aren't sure how to quantify it yet. This is our current baseline expectation for every team member.

Adaptive — You've moved beyond basic usage to building systems. You have documented workflows, you're measuring improvements, and you're consistently finding new ways to leverage AI for better outcomes. You're not just using AI—you're optimizing how you use it. This is where we expect all team members to be at over the next 12 months.

Transformative — You are changing how your team or the company operates. You're building tools and workflows that others adopt, training colleagues, and driving measurable business impact through AI innovation. You're raising the ceiling for what's possible.

The Bar Will Keep Rising

AI is evolving faster than any technology we've seen. What qualifies as Capable today will become Unacceptable within a year. What is Adaptive today will simply become the baseline expectation.

This isn't a one-time assessment. We need to embrace the growth mindset and continuously improve our skillset. This is what A players do. As I have shared in our forefronts about the [sliding scale of mediocrity](#) is that standing still in the dynamic world of tech business is akin to moving backwards.

Our goal is to be at the forefront of AI adoption in our industry. That means we innovate boldly, share what we learn, and treat AI mastery as an ongoing discipline, not a box to check.

How to Use This Rubric

1. Find your role and honestly assess where you are today.
2. Identify the specific gaps between your current level and the next.
3. Work with your manager to create a plan for leveling up.
4. Revisit quarterly—this is a living document that will evolve as AI capabilities evolve.

A Note on "Unacceptable"

We chose this word deliberately. It's not about shaming anyone. It's about clarity. In 2025 and beyond, not using AI tools is like refusing to use the internet in 2005. It's a choice that limits your effectiveness and puts extra burden on your teammates. We're committed to helping everyone reach Capable & Adaptive, but we want to ensure that the expectation is clear: staying at Unacceptable is not an option.

Delegate, Don't Abdicate

The purpose of AI is to help us accelerate our work. It doesn't replace our responsibility for the outcome.

With AI, inputs equal outputs. The quality of your direction, context, and review determines the quality of the result. Vague inputs lead to mediocre outputs. Skipping review leads to mistakes that ship.

The principle I want us to follow is to use AI as an assistant and delegate tasks to AI, but never abdicate your responsibility for the result.

- Use AI to think through problems and clarify your direction, or to move faster once you know where you're going. Both are valuable.
- Review AI outputs before they ship. Every time.
- If something goes wrong, you own it. "The AI did it" is not an answer.
- As you automate more, build in more checkpoints, not fewer.

AI adds the most value when humans lead the process and verify the result.

What This Rubric Is Not

This rubric measures AI adoption which is an important aspect of all roles, but it's not the overall job performance rubric. A Capable rating means you're at the basic level for AI usage expectations, it doesn't mean you're crushing it in all areas – same applies for all other categories too.

Your performance reviews will continue to evaluate the full scope of your work. Think of this as one critical dimension of how we work, not the only one.

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Affiliate & Partnerships

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for partner prospecting, outreach, or relationship management.
- Relies on manual processes for tasks like finding potential affiliates, researching partner sites, or drafting outreach emails.

Capable

- Uses AI to research and qualify potential affiliate partners (analyzing site traffic estimates, content relevance, audience fit) before outreach.
- Drafts personalized outreach emails and follow-up sequences with AI assistance, then edits for tone and relationship context.
- Uses AI to summarize partner performance data and identify top performers or underperforming relationships that need attention.

Adaptive

- Has a systematized AI workflow for partner discovery combining search, AI analysis, and scoring criteria to build qualified prospect lists efficiently (i.e cut prospecting time by 50%+ compared to manual research).
- Uses AI to generate partner-specific content assets (custom landing pages, co-branded copy, promotional email swipes) at scale without sacrificing quality. Success criteria be able to produce 3-4x more assets with the A.I workflow.
- Tracks AI-assisted outreach performance (response rates, conversion to active partner) and iterates on messaging based on data.
- Maintains a prompt library for common partnership tasks: outreach, negotiation talking points, contract summaries, performance reviews.

Transformative

- Builds automated or semi-automated partner nurturing workflows that increase activation rates and partner-generated revenue (i.e 30%+ more partners going active within 30 days)
- Identifies strategic partnership opportunities through AI-powered market analysis that others miss: new verticals, complementary products, or emerging affiliates.

- Documents and trains the team on AI-assisted partnership processes, raising the overall capability of the function.

Content

Unacceptable

- Relies exclusively on manual drafting and editing processes without experimenting with AI tools to improve speed or consistency.
- Creates content in silos without leveraging AI to repurpose or adapt materials for different formats (e.g., blog to email to help doc).
- Avoids or distrusts AI-powered content, SEO, readability, or analytics tools.

Capable

- Uses AI tools to draft outlines, generate first drafts, or summarize existing content, then applies careful human editing.
- Employs AI-powered SEO tools to optimize keywords and readability.

Adaptive

- Builds workflows that combine AI drafting, editing checklists, and SEO optimization to produce consistent, high-quality content more quickly.
- A/B-tests AI-generated headlines, CTAs, and content experiments with documented wins (e.g., 10%+ improvement in click-through or conversion rates on key pages).
- Uses AI to efficiently repurpose content across formats, turning tutorials into email sequences, help docs, social media posts, and videos while maintaining consistency.
- Measures content performance improvements attributable to AI workflows (e.g., 50% faster production, higher organic traffic).
- Contributes thought leadership (internal or external) on AI content best practices.

Transformative

- Trains the broader team on advanced content automation and context engineering.
- Owns the content experimentation roadmap: proposing tests, tracking results, and making data-backed recommendations that shape editorial priorities.

- Develops reusable AI prompts, templates, or style guides that elevate output quality across the content team.
- Contributes thought leadership (internal or external) on AI content best practices.

Design

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for ideation, asset generation, or design workflow optimization.
- Relies entirely on manual processes for tasks like creating mockup variations, generating placeholder imagery, or exploring design directions.

Capable

- Uses AI to accelerate ideation. Generating initial concepts, mood boards, or layout variations before refining in Figma or other design tools.
- Leverages AI image generation tools to create placeholder imagery, background assets, or illustration concepts rather than searching stock libraries for hours.
- Uses AI to generate copy variations for mockups (headlines, CTAs, microcopy) to present more realistic designs without waiting on copywriters.
- Uses AI to summarize UX research, user feedback, or analytics data to inform design decisions.

Adaptive

- Has a systematized AI workflow for asset creation that produces 3-4x more design variations in the same time as fully manual work.
- Uses AI to rapidly prototype UI concepts and landing page layouts, cutting initial mockup time by 50%+ and enabling faster stakeholder feedback loops.
- Leverages AI for batch asset production: generating multiple ad sizes, social variations, or email graphics from a single source design efficiently.
- Uses AI to analyze competitor designs, landing pages, or UI patterns at scale, extracting insights that would take hours to compile manually.
- Maintains a prompt library for different design tasks: hero images, feature graphics, social assets, UI icons, product screenshots.

Transformative

- Builds repeatable AI-assisted design workflows that measurably increase team output without sacrificing quality or brand consistency.
- Creates self-serve AI workflows (prompt templates, brand-trained tools, or documented processes) that enable non-designers i.e developers, marketers, content writers to generate on-brand assets independently, reducing design team bottlenecks.
- Uses AI to run rapid visual A/B tests. Generating and testing thumbnail, ad, or landing page variations with documented conversion improvements (e.g., 15%+ lift).
- Pioneers new AI applications for design (AI-assisted prototyping, automated asset resizing, design system generation) and evaluates practical ROI before recommending team adoption.
- Documents and trains the team on AI-assisted design processes, establishing shared prompt libraries and workflow standards that elevate output across the function.

Developers

Unacceptable

- Not using AI code agents on a regular basis.
- Spends significant time on tedious manual work (copying designs from Figma, writing boilerplate code, repetitive refactoring) that AI tools could handle in minutes.
- Calls AI coding agents 'too risky', and assumes they are producing poor code.

Capable

- Uses Cursor, Junie, Claude Code, or any other AI code agents/IDE.
- Uses AI to help plan out features, debug issues, and works with AI to write good code.
- Always verifies the AI-generated code before creating a PR.
- Uses AI chats like Gemini and others to help investigate specific features or issues.
- Uses AI to handle repetitive tasks in minutes (importing styles from Figma, generating theme.json for WP blocks, writing documentation, managing assets) instead of spending hours doing them manually.

Adaptive

- Uses AI agents/IDEs in an efficient way, knows how to best leverage AI, and has an established process to optimize code quality and implementation speed.
- Uses MCP servers to optimize AI agents with additional context or tools to help AI generate better code on the first-pass with greater accuracy.
- Uses AI-powered QA workflows to test their own work before submitting PRs: leveraging sub-agents (debugger, QA with playwright MCP, reviewer etc) to catch bugs, UI issues, and edge cases that manual testing would miss or would take too much time.
- Is always informed on the latest AI innovations, and open to testing new approaches, but does not pursue each new shiny AI object without clear goals.
- Helps out other team members by sharing their knowledge via wikis and screencasts.

Transformative

- Has an optimized process of using AI coding agents, which produce excellent code and fast implementation speed.
- AI-assisted PRs consistently pass code review with minimal revision.
- Demonstrates measurable velocity gains (2-3x) without sacrificing code quality or introducing regression bugs.
- Builds and refines AI agent configurations (QA agents, debugger agents, code review agents) in Claude Code or similar tools that systematically catch issues before human review, reducing PR revision cycles and QA team load.
- Helps out other team members by sharing their knowledge via wikis and screencasts.
- Ships AI-powered features to production that demonstrably improve user outcomes or reduce support requests.

Finance / Admin

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for analysis, reporting, or documentation tasks.

- Manually creates every report, forecast, and financial summary from scratch without exploring AI assistance.
- Dismisses AI tools without assessing their potential for improving accuracy or efficiency in financial operations.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft financial reports, summaries, and board-ready narratives, then reviews for accuracy and completeness.
- Leverages AI to analyze spreadsheets and financial data to identify anomalies, trends, or discrepancies faster than manual review.
- Uses AI to summarize long contracts, vendor agreements, or legal documents to quickly extract key financial terms.
- Uses AI to draft intercompany invoices, expense reports, and routine financial documentation rather than starting from templates each time.
- Uses AI to answer "what was our X last quarter" questions by querying financial data, reducing time spent pulling numbers manually.
- Ensures no confidential financial data is shared with external AI tools and follows data privacy protocols.

Adaptive

- Has systematized AI workflows for recurring finance tasks (monthly close summaries, variance analysis, cash flow reports) that cut preparation time by 50%+.
- Uses AI to build and iterate on forecasting models including running multiple scenarios (good / better / best) quickly to inform decision-making.
- Leverages AI to reconcile accounts, flag discrepancies, and identify patterns in expenses or revenue that warrant investigation.
- Uses AI to automate intercompany invoicing workflows, reducing manual data entry and errors across entities.
- Uses AI to prepare audit-ready documentation and supporting schedules faster, reducing end-of-year crunch.

- Maintains a prompt library for different finance tasks: variance explanations, forecast narratives, expense categorization, vendor payment summaries.
- Tracks accuracy and time savings from AI-assisted processes to guide further automation priorities.

Transformative

- Builds AI-powered financial dashboards or reporting workflows that provide real-time visibility into company health without manual data pulls.
- Uses AI to identify strategic financial insights: revenue trends, cost optimization opportunities, cash flow risks that inform executive decision-making.
- Creates self-serve AI tools or documented processes that enable non-finance team members (department heads, PMs) to pull basic financial data independently, reducing finance bottleneck.
- Develops AI-assisted forecasting systems that measurably improve forecast accuracy and reduce planning cycle time.
- Trains the finance team and cross-functional partners on AI tools for financial analysis, establishing standards for accuracy verification and data security.
- Documents AI-assisted finance workflows that make onboarding new finance team members faster and ensure process continuity.

HR

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for drafting communications, analyzing data, or streamlining HR processes.
- Manually handles every job posting, candidate communication, and HR document from scratch.
- Dismisses AI tools without assessing their potential for improving hiring efficiency or employee experience.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft job postings, candidate outreach emails, and offer letters, then edits for tone, accuracy, and compliance.

- Leverages AI to summarize resumes and candidate profiles, quickly extracting relevant experience and potential fit indicators.
- Uses AI to prepare interview questions tailored to specific roles and competencies rather than using generic question banks.
- Uses AI to draft HR documentation including policies, onboarding guides, performance review templates to help save hours of manual writing.
- Uses AI to summarize employee feedback surveys, exit interviews, or engagement data to surface key themes faster.
- Ensures no confidential employee data is shared with external AI tools and follows data privacy protocols.
- **For Recruiting:**
 - Uses AI to source candidates by generating boolean search strings, LinkedIn outreach variations, and personalized follow-ups at scale.
 - Uses AI to analyze job requirements and identify must-have vs. nice-to-have qualifications, improving candidate targeting.

Adaptive

- Has systematized AI workflows for recruiting tasks (job posting creation, candidate screening summaries, interview prep) that cut time-to-fill by 20%+ or increase qualified candidate pipeline.
- Uses AI to analyze hiring data - time in each stage, offer acceptance rates, source effectiveness—and surface patterns that improve recruiting strategy.
- Leverages AI to personalize candidate communications at scale, maintaining high-touch feel without manual effort for each message.
- Uses AI to identify flight risks or engagement issues by analyzing patterns in performance data, feedback, or communication sentiment.
- Uses AI to prepare managers for performance conversations—summarizing review history, suggesting talking points, drafting development plans.
- Maintains a prompt library for different HR tasks: job descriptions by role type, candidate outreach sequences, policy drafts, termination documentation.
- Tracks improvements in recruiting efficiency (time-to-fill, response rates) and HR process speed to guide further automation

Transformative

- Builds AI-powered recruiting workflows that measurably improve hiring outcomes: faster hires, better candidate quality, improved offer acceptance rates.
- Creates AI-assisted onboarding systems that reduce new hire ramp time and improve 90-day retention.
- Uses AI to analyze workforce data and provide strategic insights retention risk modeling, headcount planning scenarios that inform leadership decisions.
- Develops self-serve AI tools that enable hiring managers to draft job postings, screen initial candidates, or prepare interview guides independently, reducing HR bottleneck.
- Trains managers across the organization on AI tools for people management: feedback drafting, development planning, performance documentation.
- Documents AI-assisted HR processes and establishes standards for bias review, ensuring AI outputs are reviewed for fairness and compliance before use.

PPC

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for ad copy generation, keyword research, or campaign analysis.
- Manually creates every ad variation and relies solely on platform suggestions without leveraging AI for ideation or optimization.

Capable

- Uses AI to generate ad copy variations (headlines, descriptions, callouts) then edits for brand voice, compliance, and platform requirements.
- Leverages AI for keyword research and expansion. Such as finding long-tail opportunities, negative keyword candidates, competitor keyword gaps, etc.
- Uses AI to summarize campaign performance data and surface insights faster than manual spreadsheet analysis.
- Drafts landing page copy with AI assistance, ensuring message match between ads and destination pages.

Adaptive

- Has a systematized workflow for AI-assisted ad creation that produces 3-5x more testable variations in the same time as manual copywriting.
- Uses AI to analyze search term reports and competitor ads at scale, identifying optimization opportunities that would take hours to find manually.
- Runs structured tests on AI-generated ad copy with documented performance improvements (e.g., 15%+ CTR lift, 10%+ reduction in CPA).
- Maintains a prompt library tailored to different campaign types: search, display, remarketing, shopping feed optimization.
- Uses AI to generate and iterate on audience targeting ideas, ad extensions, and promotional angle variations.

Transformative

- Builds repeatable AI workflows for campaign launches that cut setup time by 50%+ while maintaining or improving performance benchmarks.
- Uses AI-powered analysis to identify strategic opportunities—new keyword territories, untapped audiences, or budget reallocation recommendations—that meaningfully move ROAS.
- Documents and trains the team on AI-assisted PPC processes, elevating capability across the function.
- Pioneers new AI applications for PPC (feed optimization, automated rules generation, cross-channel insights) and shares learnings with the broader team.

Product Managers

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for research, analysis, documentation, or strategic planning.
- Manually creates every PRD, roadmap, and competitive analysis from scratch without exploring AI assistance.
- Dismisses AI tools without assessing their potential for improving product decision-making or team efficiency.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft PRDs, feature specs, and user stories, then refines for clarity, technical accuracy, and business context.
- Leverages AI to conduct competitive research—analyzing competitor features, pricing, positioning, and market gaps faster than manual research.
- Uses AI to summarize customer feedback, support tickets, and feature requests to identify patterns and prioritize opportunities.
- Uses AI to prepare product updates, roadmap narratives, and stakeholder communications with appropriate strategic framing.
- Uses AI to query product analytics and surface insights including usage trends, feature adoption, churn indicators without waiting for analyst support.
- Uses AI to draft release notes, changelog entries, and customer-facing product announcements.
- Uses AI to prepare marketing briefs and launch materials that communicate feature value in customer-centric language, so the marketing team can do a better job.
- Uses AI tools to generate quick wireframes, mockups, or clickable prototypes to communicate ideas to designers and developers rather than describing features in text only.

Adaptive

- Has systematized AI workflows for recurring PM tasks (PRD creation, competitive analysis, roadmap updates, sprint planning inputs) that cut preparation time by 50%+.
- Uses AI to build business cases with financial projections: TAM analysis, revenue impact estimates, cost-benefit scenarios, etc that inform prioritization and resource allocation.
- Leverages AI to synthesize inputs from multiple sources (customer feedback, support data, analytics, sales insights) into actionable product recommendations.
- Uses AI to define and track feature success metrics including adoption rates, revenue impact, retention influence, etc and tying product work to business outcomes rather than just shipping features.
- Uses AI to create marketing-ready positioning, messaging frameworks, and competitive differentiators that enable marketing teams to launch effectively without extensive back-and-forth.
- Uses AI to analyze launch performance and generate post-launch reports that connect feature releases to business results (expansion revenue, churn reduction, NPS improvement).

- Uses AI to run scenario planning for roadmap decisions modeling different sequencing options, resource tradeoffs, and market timing considerations – a.k.a having AI do the O+I analysis.
- Uses AI to identify feature opportunities by analyzing competitor gaps, customer pain points, and market trends at scale.
- Uses AI to prepare development teams for upcoming work: generating technical context, edge case considerations, and acceptance criteria that reduce back-and-forth.
- Uses AI-powered design tools to produce functional mockups and basic UX flows independently, enabling faster stakeholder feedback and reducing designer bottleneck on early-stage exploration.
- Iterates on AI-generated prototypes based on feedback before involving designers, so design time is spent on polish and edge cases rather than initial concepting.
- Maintains a prompt library for different PM tasks: PRDs by feature type, competitive battle cards, pricing analysis, launch planning checklists, marketing briefs.

Transformative

- Uses AI to build strategic product frameworks for market positioning, pricing optimization, expansion revenue models that measurably impact business outcomes (revenue growth, market share, customer retention).
- Creates AI-powered product health dashboards that provide real-time visibility into feature adoption, customer satisfaction, and revenue impact without manual reporting.
- Builds AI workflows that enable cross-functional partners (developers, designers, QA, project managers, marketing) to self-serve on product context, reducing PM as a bottleneck.
- Uses AI to identify strategic opportunities including new market segments, product line extensions, partnership possibilities, etc through data synthesis that would take weeks manually.
- Develops AI-assisted prioritization systems that improve roadmap quality and stakeholder alignment, with documented impact on delivery predictability and business results.
- Trains product team and cross-functional partners on AI tools for product thinking i.e customer research synthesis, competitive analysis, business case development, etc.
- Shares product AI best practices across the organization, establishing standards that elevate PM capability company-wide.

Project Management

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for planning, documentation, or communication tasks.
- Manually creates every status update, meeting summary, and project document from scratch.
- Dismisses AI tools without assessing their potential benefits for project efficiency.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft project documentation such as PRDs, briefs, timelines, status updates and then edits for accuracy / context.
- Leverages AI to summarize long Slack threads, meeting recordings, or email chains to quickly extract action items and decisions.
- Uses AI to prepare meeting agendas and generate meeting notes, reducing administrative overhead by 50%+.
- Uses AI to draft stakeholder communications (project updates, delay explanations, scope change requests) with appropriate tone and clarity.
- Uses AI to query project history or documentation to answer "what did we decide about X" questions without digging through old threads.

Adaptive

- Has systematized AI workflows for recurring PM tasks (sprint planning, retrospective summaries, release notes, stakeholder updates) that cut preparation time significantly.
- Uses AI to analyze project data - velocity trends, blockers, missed deadlines - and surface patterns that inform better planning and resource allocation.
- Leverages AI to identify risks and dependencies across projects by synthesizing information from multiple sources (Github, Zenhub, Slack, docs) faster than manual review.
- Uses AI to generate multiple scenario plans (optimistic, realistic, pessimistic timelines) when scoping new projects or responding to scope changes.
- Maintains a prompt library for different PM tasks: kickoff docs, status reports, retrospective facilitation, escalation communications.

- Tracks time saved on administrative tasks and reallocates that time to higher-value work like unblocking teams or improving processes.

Transformative

- Builds AI-powered PM workflows or templates that other project managers can adopt, raising efficiency across the function.
- Uses AI to create real-time project health dashboards or automated status summaries that reduce manual reporting burden across teams.
- Identifies bottlenecks in the development process through AI-assisted analysis and implements solutions that measurably improve delivery speed or predictability.
- Trains developers, product managers, and other stakeholders on AI tools that improve async communication and reduce meeting load.
- Documents and shares PM best practices for AI adoption, establishing standards that make onboarding new PMs faster.

QA

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for test planning, test case generation, or bug analysis.
- Relies entirely on manual processes for repetitive testing tasks that AI could accelerate.

Capable

- Uses AI to generate test cases from feature specs, PRs, or user stories: covering edge cases and scenarios that might be overlooked manually.
- Leverages AI to draft bug reports with clear reproduction steps, expected vs. actual behavior, and severity assessment.
- Uses AI to analyze error logs, stack traces, or user reports to quickly identify root cause patterns.
- Uses AI to summarize release notes or changelogs to prioritize testing focus areas.

Adaptive

- Has a systematized AI workflow for test case generation that produces comprehensive test coverage in 50%+ less time than manual planning.
- Uses AI-powered visual testing or screen-aware agents to automate UI/UX regression checks across browsers, devices, or screen sizes.
- Leverages AI to analyze historical bug data and identify patterns such as recurring issue types, problematic code areas, or features that need deeper coverage.
- Uses AI to generate and maintain test documentation, keeping test plans current without manual overhead.
- Maintains a prompt library for different QA tasks: test case generation, bug triage, regression planning, exploratory testing checklists.

Transformative

- Builds AI-powered QA workflows that developers can run pre-PR, shifting bug detection earlier and reducing QA team bottlenecks.
- Creates and refines AI agent configurations (visual QA agents, accessibility checkers, cross-browser testers) that catch issues automated scripts miss.
- Uses AI to identify gaps in test coverage across the product, recommending strategic improvements that reduce production bugs by measurable amounts (e.g., 20%+ fewer post-release issues).
- Documents and trains both QA team and developers on AI-assisted testing processes, elevating quality ownership across the organization.

Support (Customer Success)

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for drafting responses, researching issues, or analyzing customer patterns.
- Handles every ticket from scratch without leveraging AI to accelerate resolution or improve response quality.

- Views role as purely reactive ticket resolution rather than proactive customer relationship building.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft ticket responses, then edits for accuracy, tone, and personalization before sending.
- Leverages AI to quickly research customer issues—querying documentation, past tickets, or knowledge bases to find solutions faster.
- Uses AI to summarize customer history (past tickets, feature usage, account status) before engaging, enabling more informed conversations.
- Uses AI to identify upsell or cross-sell opportunities based on customer questions or usage patterns (e.g., "customer asking about X feature that's in Pro plan").
- Uses AI to translate technical solutions into beginner-friendly language that matches the customer's expertise level.

Adaptive

- Has systematized AI workflows for common ticket types that cut response time by 50%+ while maintaining quality and personalization.
- Uses AI to analyze ticket patterns and proactively flag at-risk customers (repeated issues, frustrated tone, feature gaps) for outreach before they churn.
- Leverages AI to identify expansion opportunities at scale such as surfacing customers who would benefit from upgrades, add-ons, or additional products based on usage and inquiry patterns.
- Uses AI to draft proactive outreach messages (check-ins, feature announcements, upgrade suggestions) personalized to customer context.
- Tracks metrics that reflect the shift to customer success: expansion revenue influenced, churn prevented, proactive outreach conversion rates.
- Maintains a prompt library for different scenarios: technical troubleshooting, billing issues, upgrade conversations, renewal outreach, win-back campaigns.

Transformative

- Builds AI-powered workflows that identify and prioritize high-value customer success opportunities including upgrades, renewals at risk, and expansion timing across the entire

customer base.

- Creates proactive outreach playbooks powered by AI that measurably increase expansion revenue (e.g., 15%+ lift in upgrade conversions from outreach campaigns).
- Develops AI-assisted health scoring or early warning systems that reduce churn by catching at-risk accounts before they cancel.
- Trains the broader support team on the shift from reactive support to proactive success, with documented frameworks for balancing ticket load with outreach.
- Shares insights from customer conversations with product and marketing teams, using AI to synthesize feedback patterns into actionable recommendations.

Video Team

Unacceptable

- Does not use AI tools for scripting, research, or video optimization.
- Relies entirely on manual processes for tasks like writing scripts, researching topics, generating thumbnails concepts, or analyzing video performance.

Capable

- Uses AI to research video topics: identifying trending questions, competitor video gaps, and keyword opportunities before scripting.
- Drafts video scripts with AI assistance, then edits for our brands beginner-friendly tone, pacing, and accuracy.
- Uses AI to generate title and thumbnail concepts, testing multiple options before finalizing.
- Leverages AI to write video descriptions, tags, and timestamps rather than treating them as afterthoughts.
- Uses AI to summarize video analytics and identify patterns (drop-off points, high-engagement sections, CTR trends).

Adaptive

- Has a systematized AI workflow for script development that cuts scripting time by 50%+ while maintaining tutorial clarity and accuracy.

- Uses AI to analyze top-performing videos (own and competitor) and extract patterns: hook structures, pacing, CTA placement that help us create better new content.
- Tests AI-generated titles and thumbnail concepts with documented improvements in CTR (e.g., 15%+ lift on optimized videos).
- Uses AI to efficiently repurpose long-form tutorials into Shorts, Reels, or TikToks—producing 3-4x more short-form content from existing assets.
- Maintains a prompt library for different video types: tutorials, product launches, feature announcements, comparison videos.

Transformative

- Builds repeatable AI-assisted production workflows that increase video output without sacrificing quality.
- Uses AI-powered analysis to shape content strategy: identifying underserved topics, optimal posting patterns, or format experiments that measurably grow channel performance (subscribers, watch time, views).
- Uses AI to create high quality UGC content with consistent brand avatars that can be incorporated into our regular video strategy.
- Documents and trains the team on AI-assisted video processes, with clear before/after metrics on production efficiency.

Broader Ops Role

Unacceptable

- Dismisses or avoids AI tools without assessing their potential operational benefits, limitations, or risks.
- Runs operational work entirely manually despite clear opportunities for AI assistance in documentation, analysis, or planning.
- Treats AI as irrelevant to operations rather than as a tool for improving execution, efficiency, or reliability.

Capable

- Uses AI to draft standard operating procedures, onboarding materials, training content, and meeting summaries, then reviews and edits for accuracy and context.
- Leverages AI to summarize operational data, reviews, or retrospectives to reduce manual effort and speed up understanding.
- Applies AI to sanity-check plans & Ideas.
- Follows & encourages company guidelines for safe AI usage, ensuring confidential or restricted information is not shared with external tools.

Adaptive

- Builds AI-assisted workflows to generate and maintain onboarding guides, SOPs, and project templates, materially reducing preparation time and rework.
- Uses AI to analyze operational patterns such as recurring bottlenecks, or execution risks, and acts on those insights proactively.
- Tracks measurable improvements in speed, consistency, or quality to guide where further automation or optimization is worthwhile.
- Maintains reusable prompt libraries and tools for core Ops tasks (planning, reviews, post-mortems, documentation, reporting).

Transformative

- Redesigns critical operations processes using AI in ways that significantly improve turnaround times, scalability, or execution reliability.
- Builds AI-powered systems or workflows that others rely on for planning, reporting, or operational decision-making.
- Trains colleagues across teams to use AI tools safely and effectively, embedding AI usage into standard operational practices.

- Establishes and operationalizes clear guidelines for ethical and secure AI use that are consistently followed across the organization.
- Drives measurable business impact through Ops-led AI initiatives (e.g., fewer escalations, faster delivery cycles, improved cross-team throughput).

FAQs

Where can I find resources to reach Transformative level? Who can guide me?

The honest answer is there may not be someone in your role who's already Transformative. And that's the point. Transformative isn't about following a playbook someone else created. It's about taking ownership, experimenting, learning from what's working across the industry, and sharing what you discover with the team.

Start by exploring AI tools relevant to your role, following thought leaders in your field, and experimenting with workflows. When you find something that works, document it and share it. That's how you become Transformative, and that's how you help others get there too.

What if I'm struggling to reach Capable?

Talk to your manager ASAP. We're committed to helping everyone get to Capable. That may include training, pairing with a teammate who's further along, and/or dedicated time to experiment with AI tools.

But I need you to be transparent with your manager and reach out ASAP. If you feel you're not getting enough guidance from your manager, please ping HR and Syed directly because we want to help.

What if my role isn't listed in this rubric?

The principles apply across all roles. Find the rubric closest to your function and adapt it. If you're unsure, talk to your manager about what Capable, Adaptive, and Transformative look like for your specific responsibilities.

Lastly, please ping the HR team and Syed, so this can be added in the rubric.

Will AI replace my job?

AI is here to amplify your work, not replace you. But I want our expectation to be very clear: team members who refuse to adopt AI will fall behind. The goal is to use AI to help us do more, faster, and better.

How often will I be evaluated on this rubric?

This rubric will be part of quarterly conversations with your manager. It's not a one-time assessment. As AI evolves, so will the rubric and expectations. I very much expect that what's Capable today will become Unacceptable in the coming months, and Adaptive will be the benchmark for Capable.

Do I need to use specific AI tools?

No. The rubric focuses on outcomes, not tools. Use whatever AI tools help you do better work faster, as long as you follow our data privacy guidelines.

Our team members have access to all the latest models through Chatty. Everyone also has access to Gemini Pro through our Google Workspace.

For developers, you can request access to Cursor or Claude Code. Ping your team manager for access.

For other roles, we routinely buy subscriptions to experiment with and try new tools that you believe will help with the company's goals and achieving the outcomes.

Where can I go to learn AI and improve my skills?

There aren't any specific expert courses that we have purchased because the space is moving so fast. Whenever a course does come out, it's already outdated.

The best places to learn AI would be YouTube and / or following the respective influencers in your particular role on X or LinkedIn.

Of course, you can also use the official resources from Gemini, OpenAI and Claude because these are usually up to date and contains best practices.

Gemini: <https://ai.google/learn-ai-skills/> and <https://www.skills.google/> (make sure you use your AM account so you can access for free)

OpenAI: <https://academy.openai.com/>

Claude: <https://support.claude.com/en/> and <https://anthropic.skilljar.com/>